

Trees

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Solution of the practice quiz

If two persons with a common ancestor have a child, it forms a cycle in the network. Indeed, the child is connected with the common ancestor with two paths: one through her father, and one through her mother. Therefore, the network representing a “family tree” is not a tree.

For example, considering the family tree of the kings of France, there is a cycle through Philippe VI Valois (1293-1350) and Louis VIII (1187–1226), as illustrated below. Louis VIII is the great-grandfather of both parents of Philippe VI Valois.

